# MACH1 / FleetLine E1

## Who we build for — and why

> *### The buyer is a fleet operator, not a driver.*
> *Driver economics improve **because** the operator's do. Every commercial conversation about a fleet vehicle ends at an operations manager's desk — and that person buys on cost per kilometre and utilisation, not on take-home pay.*
>
> ***Structurally, drivers now choose the platform; operators choose the vehicle.***

## 1. Who the buyer is

Our buyer is the fleet operator running 5,000–40,000 vehicles in Indian metros — Ola and Uber, Refex, Everest, Lithium Urban, and the airport-specialist entrants that refilled the gap when BluSmart exited: Evera across Delhi terminals, GMR Hyderabad's 200-plus vehicle premium airport fleet, and Bharat Taxi at Navi Mumbai.

| | |
|---|---|
| **40,000–50,000** | ride-hailing vehicles in our addressable metros |
| **8,000–10,000** | of those already electric |
| **1** | replacement window now open |

*India has roughly 40,000–50,000 ride-hailing vehicles in our addressable metros, of which about 8,000–10,000 are already electric. The operator has already started replacing. This is the replacement window.*

## 2. Why this audience for this competition

Because this competition is about the **high-utilisation fleet duty cycle** — a narrow, measurable segment. We deliberately did not try to serve the largest one.

| | VOLUME sits here | MARGIN sits here |
|---|---|---|
| **Use case** | Street-hail intra-city | Airport + corporate commute |
| **Share of rides** | ~58% | ~19% combined |
| **Paid km/day** | ~95 | **144–210** |
| **Dispatch** | unpredictable | **pre-booked** |
| **Price sensitivity** | 0.85 | **0.30–0.35** |
| **EV adoption today** | 10% | **18%** |

> *### Under India's new flat-fee platform economics — Ola at ₹67 per vehicle per day, ### Uber and Rapido at ₹29 — revenue per vehicle is **fixed**. ### The only variable left is **paid kilometres per day**. ### Utilisation, not fare, decides the economics now.*

Those two segments **require different vehicles**. A vehicle engineered for the margin segment is structurally wrong for the volume segment — the duty cycle, the charging access and the economics do not transfer.

So we specified for the margin segment, **and said out loud that we are not claiming the volume segment.**

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## 3. What actually matters to them, in order

| Rank | Criterion | Why |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Cost per kilometre, all-in** | Every credible fleet TCO study converges here |
| 2 | **Paid km/day** | The binding constraint under flat-fee economics |
| 3 | **Uptime** | Charging downtime is the failure they actually fear |
| 4 | **Depot control** | Without controlled overnight charging, the electric case does not close |
| 5 | **Residual value** | BluSmart assumed 10% and realised 26% — our exact segment published their own number |
| 6 | **Financeability** | Financing structure alone is worth about 8 points of advantage |
| 7 | **Range** | **Last.** 315 km against a 200 km/day duty is ample |

*Rank 7 is a deliberate point, not a forgotten one.*

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## 4. Two things that cut against the usual pitch

> ***Range is not a decision driver for this buyer.*** *It sits at the bottom of the list. If your deck leads with range, it is leading with the wrong number.*

> ***The buyer's fear is downtime, not range.*** *An operator cannot send a driver home if the vehicle is charging when it should be earning. That is why our specification leans on depot control, and why **per-cell State-of-Health telemetry is specified rather than optional** — it is the mechanism that makes an eight-year capacity-retention guarantee credible at all, given published LFP studies disagree **3.6**× on time-to-80%.*

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*Every figure here traces to the market assessment (`MACH1_MARKET_ASSESSMENT.md`) and the TCO analysis (`MACH1_TCO_ANALYSIS.md`). Full source list in those documents.*

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> ***On framing.*** *"Why this audience" is strongest when it admits a limit rather than claiming the whole market. Saying we measured intra-city, that it was 58% of the volume, and that it is the wrong vehicle for this design — that is a stronger position than claiming everything. And it is much harder for a judge to argue with, because the reasoning is visible.*